P2JW263000-8-A00100-16DDF61078D



WSJ

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL WEEKEND



DOW JONES | News Corp ******** SATURDAY/SUNDAY, SEPTEMBER 20 - 21, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 69 WSJ.com ★★★★ $6.00

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Trump announced a move** to dramatically reshape the nation's immigration system, attaching hefty new fees to H-1B visas and rolling out a "gold card" for those willing to pay $1 million to secure U.S. residency. **A1**

◆ **Trump and Chinese leader** Xi approved a preliminary deal for a group of investors to take control of TikTok's U.S. operations. **A1**

◆ **The Trump administration** flexed its new authority over U.S. Steel, blocking its plan to shut down production at an Illinois plant this fall. **A2**

◆ **Rising operating costs**, falling coal prices and high royalties are straining Australia's massive steelmaking coal mines, triggering layoffs and pit closures. **B9**

◆ **Blackstone picked** another top female executive to head its real-estate mega-fund following the fatal shooting of the fund's former CEO, Wesley LePatner. **B9**

◆ **Porsche warned on profit** for the fourth time this year and said that unpredictable demand forced it to delay the new all-EV models. **B9**

◆ **Stocks closed the week** at record highs, propelled by investor optimism that the Federal Reserve will keep cutting interest rates—and keep the market rally going. **B10**

World-Wide

◆ **Health Secretary** Robert F. Kennedy Jr.'s handpicked vaccine advisers voted to nix positive recommendations for Covid shots for adults, and instead advised "individual decision-making" for all Americans. **A1, A4**

◆ **A top federal prosecutor** who has been under pressure to bring criminal charges against New York Attorney General Letitia James, a vocal Trump critic, has resigned after the president said he wanted him ousted. **A3**

◆ **Senate Democrats blocked** Republicans' stopgap measure to keep the government funded until late November, setting up negotiations over how to avoid a shutdown. **A3**

◆ **A federal judge struck** Trump's $15 billion defamation lawsuit against the New York Times, characterizing it as a screed that violated basic court rules for suing someone. **A3**

◆ **Trump said he ordered** a lethal military strike on a vessel allegedly carrying drugs to the U.S., marking at least the third such strike on Latin America-based cartels. **A8**

◆ **The administration** and Afghanistan are discussing reestablishing a small U.S. military counterterrorism force at a former U.S. air base. **A7**

◆ **The head of Britain's** foreign-intelligence agency, MI6, warned that Russia's Putin has no desire to end the war in Ukraine. **A8**

NOONAN
Gatekeepers and national traumas **A13**

CONTENTS

Books	C7-12	Obituaries	C6
Business & Finance	B9	Opinion	A11-13
Food	D8-9	Sports	A10
Gear & Gadgets	D11	Style & Fashion	D2-4
Heard on Street	B12	Travel	D6
Markets	B10	U.S. News	A2-4,6
		World News	A7-8

© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc.
All Rights Reserved

Paris Completes the Comeback of Notre Dame



LUDOVIC MARIN/PRESS POOL

FRENCH GOTHIC: President Emmanuel Macron of France attends the inauguration of the two medieval towers of Notre Dame Cathedral on Friday, the eve of their reopening to the public, more than six years after a fire devastated the landmark.

RFK Jr.'s Vaccine Panel Drops Covid Shot Recommendations

Health secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. handpicked vaccine advisers voted on Friday to nix positive recommendations for Covid shots for adults, and instead advised "individual decision-making" for all Americans, a move that capped an often chaotic two-day meeting in which participants reversed one vote and postponed another.

*By **Liz Essley Whyte** in Atlanta and **Sabrina Siddiqui** in Washington*

The panel's unanimous Covid vote means that U.S. adults no longer are recommended to get the Covid shot, if the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention acting director signs off on the panel's guidance.

The committee, known as the Advisory Committee on Immunization Practices, said adults 65 and older should decide on Covid vaccines individually or with a doctor. The panel added that individual decisions also be made for people between ages 6 months and 64, while emphasizing those who have underlying conditions are the people most likely to benefit from the shots.

The CDC previously dropped the recommendation for children and pregnant women this summer, after Kennedy, a longtime critic of vaccines, announced the move on social media.

The new guidance may make it difficult for Americans who

Please turn to page A4

◆ **MAHA ran into farmers, industry groups** A4

Trump Raises Visa Fees For Tech Workers

Move to tack on $100,000 cost hits H-1B system popular in Silicon Valley

By Natalie Andrews And Michelle Hackman

WASHINGTON—President Trump announced a move to dramatically reshape the nation's immigration system, attaching hefty new fees to H-1B visas and rolling out a "gold card" for those willing to pay $1 million to secure U.S. residency.

A new $100,000 annual fee for H-1B visa applications is intended to crack down on a system the Trump administration says has been used by tech companies to avoid hiring American workers. Currently, applicants for the H-1B visa must pay a small fee to enter into a lottery system, and the winners of that lottery pay a larger fee to submit their full applications for vetting.

"We're having people come in, people that in many cases are very successful or whatever, as opposed to walking over the borders," Trump said in the Oval Office.

An executive order signed by Trump on Friday also rolls out a gold card available to people who pay $1 million to the U.S. Treasury. Corporations can sponsor an individual for $2 million. The visas are expedited, and the Department of Homeland Security will still vet the individuals, which will cost applicants $15,000. Commerce Secretary

Please turn to page A6

Investors Bet Rates Will Fall Rapidly

By Sam Goldfarb

Wall Street thinks interest rates are poised to come down faster than the Federal Reserve does—a wager that's already boosting the economy and markets by making it cheaper for Americans to borrow.

Bets in the futures market show investors expect that the Fed's benchmark short-term rate will fall just below 3% by the end of next year, from slightly above 4% now, according to LSEG data. That marks a sizable shift from May, when investors thought that rates would fall only to around 3.5% at the end of 2026.

It is also below what most Fed officials are forecasting. Their latest "dot plot" showed a median expectation that rates end next year at 3.4%—the equivalent of two fewer quarter-point rate cuts than investors are anticipating.

With stocks at record highs, investors are hoping that they can have it all: substantially lower rates without that much risk of a recession. Some warn that they could end up disappointed.

Investors' expectations for short-term interest rates matter because—even more than the current level of rates set by

Please turn to page A2

◆ **Fed rate cut won't ease U.S. debt burden** A2
◆ **Miran makes his case for steeper rate reductions** ... A2

EXCHANGE



HELLO [NAME]
Inside the Starbucks plan to get 200,000 baristas on the same script. **B1**

AI CEO Fights White House Over the Future of Technology

Battle between Anthropic and the administration pits worries about safe development against a free-market approach

By Berber Jin and Amrith Ramkumar

While Sam Altman, Tim Cook and other titans of technology took turns praising President Trump at a White House dinner two weeks ago, Anthropic Chief Executive Dario Amodei was back home in California.

The head of one of the world's top artificial-intelligence startups has taken a very different approach to politics. Amodei is an outspoken critic of Trump's AI agenda, arguing its laissez-faire approach could steer the technology down a dangerous path. At times he's ignored even his own policy advisers who suggested dialing down the opposition.

Amodei likened Trump to a "feudal warlord" in a lengthy pre-election Facebook post urging friends to vote for Kamala Harris. In March, he fired the legal giant Skadden Arps after learning it had struck a settlement with Trump, telling staff that Anthropic wouldn't work with law firms he felt were caving to an assault on the rule of law. He is also cutting ties with Latham & Watkins, which similarly made a deal with the president.

The moves might seem unusually aggressive for a scientist turned CEO known to some of his employees as Professor Panda. And they have locked his company in a high-stakes battle with the Trump administration—especially with the face of its AI strat-

Please turn to page A9

At Sewage Super Bowl, Teams Vie For No. 1 Spot in No. 2 Business

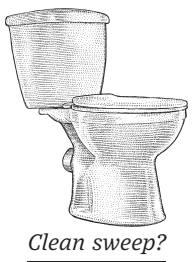
* * *

A fierce rivalry is gripping the world of competitive water treatment

By Ed Ballard

Talk about water pressure.

America's elite sewage operators are headed to Chicago this month to test their skills to the limit, from high-speed pump repairs to a mock manhole rescue.



Clean sweep?

It's the Super Bowl of wastewater treatment, and an era-defining rivalry is gripping the profession like a wrench tightening a flange nut on a sludge pipe.

Two teams are vying for all-time-great status after trading the national title for six years straight: reigning champions Elevated Ops, representing Denver's Metro Water Recovery, and Controlled Chaos of Mount Pleasant Waterworks in South Carolina. Insiders expect a nail-biter.

Please turn to page A9

U.S., China Set Path For TikTok Agreement

WASHINGTON—President Trump and Chinese leader Xi Jinping approved a preliminary agreement for a group of investors to take control of

*By **Amrith Ramkumar, Alex Leary** and **Lingling Wei***

TikTok's U.S. operations, setting the stage for further negotiations while the two sides hammer out details.

Under the framework, U.S. investors would take control of the video-sharing app through a new entity that would operate algorithms using technology licensed from TikTok parent ByteDance, a structure designed to alleviate national-security concerns associated with millions of Americans using a platform controlled by a Chinese firm.

The U.S. is expected to receive a multibillion dollar fee from investors, the latest in a string of lucrative government deals with the private sector.

"I just completed a very productive call with President Xi of China. We made progress on many very important issues including trade, fentanyl, the need to bring the war between Russia and Ukraine to an end, and the approval of

Please turn to page A8